

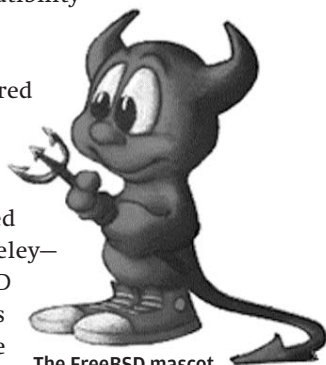
GE and MIT as partners. Multics (Multiplexed Information and Computing Service) was a time-sharing OS that ran on a special, expensive CPU. It was later marketed by Honeywell as a commercial product to the US Government, and to auto makers, universities, and commercial data processing services. But as it went on, the project sailed through rough waters and experienced delays. Eventually, Bell Labs withdrew from the project in 1969.

A lot more happened in 1969—apart from the moon landing and Bryan Adam's Summer! The scientists from Bell who worked on the Multics Project developed the first-ever UNIX, an OS meant for servers. Linus Torvalds was born the same year.

1.1.2 UNIX

When Bell Labs developed UNIX—one of the most well-known operating systems of all time—it was initially distributed for free, and gained great popularity in universities. The big boost for UNIX came when the TCP/IP protocol stack was implemented, and UNIX was adopted as the OS of choice for early workstations and servers. Quick development followed, and by 1979 the seventh version of UNIX was introduced. During this time (1972 to be precise), Dennis Ritchie developed C, the base for almost all medium- and high-level programming languages developed after it till date. C was used to write software on the UNIX kernel to make a complete OS. C, therefore, can be very easily used to write applications for UNIX, with compatibility not being an issue.

Apart from Linux, UNIX has inspired other OSES as well, notably BSD, short for Berkeley Software Distribution. BSD, a UNIX-based OS that can run on various CPU architectures, was developed in the University of California at Berkeley—hence the name. Outside of Bell Labs, BSD contributed the most to UNIX. It was intended more for experimental use



The FreeBSD mascot